

הַמִּגִּלָּה וְאֵחָד מֵאֵלֶּיךָ

For those reading the Megillah on Mivtzoim 5777 – the greatest Purim ever.

- The Megillah at night may be read from Tzeis Hakochavim (this year: 6:34pm) until alos. However one should make every effort to fulfill the mitzvah as early as possible. The Megillah may be read during the day from Netz (7:07am) until Shkia (6:54pm) Bidieved, if you read the Megilla from alos (5:40am) you are yotze.
- It is better to hear the Megillah in a place where there are many people, but there should be at least a Minyan. However, it is permitted to read the megillah even if there is no minyan. When there are no ten men hearing the Megillah for the first time that night or that day, the brocho of HaRav es Riveinu is not said. (Nitei Gavriel Purim 47:5).
- One cannot fulfill his obligation of hearing the Megillah if it is heard via telephone, live hookup, or microphone.
- The one reading the Megillah rolls out the complete Megillah and then folds it into three (so it should be like a letter).
- The reader should read the Megillah while standing.
- When the Ba'al Koreh says the Brochos, everyone who wants to fulfill the mitzvah should pay close attention to the Brochos, **not answer Baruch Hu uVaruch Shemo**, but answer Amen and have in mind to want to fulfill the mitzvah. If one by mistake did say Baruch Hu uVaruch Shemo, it is acceptable and there is no need to repeat the Brocho.
- If the Ba'al Koreh has already heard the megillah and thus fulfilled the mitzvah, it is advisable that one of the men listening should say the bracha. He can also say it in English. Otherwise, the Baal Koreh makes it for them. If you are leining for a woman, she should say the bracha "*Vitzivanu lishmoah megillah*" If you are leining for a group of only women, either they all say the bracha "*lishmoah megillah*" together or the Baal Koreh says the bracha "*lishmoah megillah*"
- When saying Shehecheyanu at the morning reading, one should have in mind that this blessing should also include the mitzvos of Mishloach Monos, Matanos Loevyonim and Seudah.
- If someone arrives a bit late and the reader is already saying the Brochos, make sure he says the Brochos himself and make sure he finishes it before the reading begins.
- You may not talk between the Brocho and the beginning of Leining the Megillah. If the one who is being yotze spoke, he must repeat the Brochoh.

- One is **not** permitted to talk at all while the Megillah is being read until after the Brocho of "*Harav es riveinu*." (If you did, it is not considered a Hefsek).

- If the person that is hearing the Megillah spoke, make sure to go back to the words he didn't hear and continue from there.

- After reading Haman's name, the reader must be careful to wait until all the noisemaking ends before starting to read again. A careful Ba'al Koreh will start again from the word Haman.

- The following four Pesukim everyone reads before the Ba'al Koreh;

אִישׁ יְהוּדִי, וּמְרַדְכֵי יָצָא, לַיהוּדִים, כִּי מְרַדְכֵי

- By the Possuk בלילה הוא the Ba'al Koreh raises his voice.

- פרק ט' פסוק ג' "ולהרוג ולאבד" are read again as "ולהרוג ולאבד". In פרק ט' פסוק ז' "ואיש לא עמד בפניהם" are read again as "ואיש לא עמד בפניהם".

- The Aseres Bnei Homon - from "chameish meos" until "aseres" - are read in one breath; everyone says them before the Ba'al Koreh.

- You should shake the Megillah by the words "האגרת הזאת" "אגרת הפורים הזאת השנית"

- We only roll up the Megillah after the Brocho of "*Harav es riveinu*".

Note (not really noge'ah on mitzvot): Although one should have a "kosher" Megillah (i.e., handwritten on parchment) so that if he misses a word or two he will be able to read it from the megillah, if bedi'eved one was paying attention from a printed text and missed a few words or a pasuk and read it from the printed text, he has still fulfilled the mitzvah. (Piskei Teshuvos 689:7)

- Don't forget to do the Mitzvos of Matanos Loevyonim and Mishloach Manos with everyone, and explain the mitzva of Seudah

Important: Do not forget to do the other three
Mitzvos yourself!!



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